

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818

The musical score is written in 6/8 time and features four-part vocal harmony (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) with guitar accompaniment. The guitar part uses a mix of open and fretted chords, indicated by 'x' and 'o' symbols on the fretboard diagrams. The lyrics are arranged in four parts, with the first part being the original German text and the subsequent parts being English translations. The score is divided into three systems, each with a guitar chord diagram above the first staff. The first system covers the first four lines of the lyrics, the second system covers the next four lines, and the third system covers the final four lines. The music is written in a simple, accessible style, suitable for amateur musicians.

System 1:

Guitar Chords: C, G, C

1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight,
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light,
4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light,

System 2:

Guitar Chords: F, C, F, C

round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild,
glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia,
ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace,
with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King,

System 3:

Guitar Chords: G, C, G, C

sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born."
Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.